CLASS 10 — ENGLISH · HARD LEVEL CHAPTER TEST SET 2

Chapter 27: **The Tale of Custard the Dragon (First Flight Poem)** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 1 Hour 30 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 40**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–10 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 11–14 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 15–18 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 19–20 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 17 to 20.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. Hard level: application and higher-order questions.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 10 × 1 = 10

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. The metre mimics: 1

(a) a prayer **(b)** a funeral march
(c) a galloping, bouncy rhythm **(d)** a lecture

2. A feature of the narrative voice is its: 1

(a) amused omniscience **(b)** bitterness
(c) first-person confession **(d)** silence

3. The poem's resolution is: 1

(a) religious **(b)** scientific
(c) tragic **(d)** comic, not moralistic

4. The invented 'realio, trulio' is an example of: 1

(a) jargon **(b)** archaism
(c) dialect **(d)** neologism for comic emphasis

5. The poem relies on the reader's knowledge of: 1

(a) history of Rome **(b)** geography
(c) dragon and pirate stories **(d)** chemistry

6. A reader interested in sound would note: 1

(a) only prose **(b)** no rhyme
(c) end-rhymes and internal echoes **(d)** no rhythm

7. The poem satirises: 1

(a) pirates **(b)** bravery **(c)** empty bravado **(d)** dragons

8. The poem's popularity is partly due to its: 1

(a) oral quality **(b)** complex plot
(c) length **(d)** difficult language

9. Which statement is a valid criticism? 1

(a) The poem is too serious **(b)** The poem has no story
(c) The poem has no humour **(d)** Characters are types, not deep portraits

10. A deeper moral is that: 1

(a) courage is revealed by action when it matters
(b) dragons are fierce
(c) pirates are cowards
(d) pets are weak

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) 4 × 2 = 8

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

11. What does the poem suggest about public reputation versus truth? 2

12. Why is the poem suited to being read aloud? 2

13. How do the names function beyond humour? 2

14. How is the pirate a foil to Custard? 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) 4 × 3 = 12

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

15. Discuss how the poet manipulates reader expectations about dragons and pirates. 3

16. Discuss the role of hyperbole in the poem. 3

17. Replace 'brave' with three precise words and use one. 3

OR

Analyse the effect of sound devices such as rhyme and repetition. 3

18. How is the poem's world enclosed and safe, and how does the pirate disrupt it? 3

OR

Identify two comic devices in the poem and explain. 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

19. Write an essay on the theme of misjudged character in the poem and in any other lesson you have studied. 5

OR

Analyse how the poem makes use of contrast. 5

20. Compare Custard with the young seagull ('His First Flight') as characters who overcome fear. 5

OR

Evaluate whether the poem encourages bravery or acceptance of fear. 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER Total: 40 Marks

MASTERMIND